friends from Hollywood, in *Sugar Babies*. At the final curtain, Mickey asked the audience to stay in place until we exited, and as we went up the aisle, the audience began singing "America the Beautiful"—more lump-in-throat time.

The next night, we went to the Met to see the Joffrey Ballet. Our son Ron had flown in from the road company for the performance. I think I held my breath for the whole show, but he was great and didn't need any fatherly prayers. He had a grace that reminded me of Fred Astaire, an extra flair that made what he was doing look easy.

When I got back to Washington, the pending and difficult question of how to deal with the growing flood of Japanese car imports at a time when our economy needed every bit of help it could find took center stage and came to a head at a meeting at the White House on March 19. The special task force I'd appointed under Drew Lewis to review the problem wanted to impose mandatory quotas on the Japanese. But several members of the cabinet, including Don Regan, the treasury secretary, and David Stockman, head of the Office of Management and Budget, strongly opposed it. George Shultz, who chaired a volunteer economic advisory committee, was strongly in opposition. They argued that it would violate our commitment to free enterprise and free trade.

I agreed with them but kept quiet. In Washington, I was following the same practice I had followed in Sacramento: I invited all the members of the cabinet to give me their views on all sides of an issue (everything except the "political ramifications" of my decision) and sometimes, as in this case, the result was a heated debate—and if I was leaning a certain way, I tried not to tip my advisors off, to ensure that I'd hear all sides.

As I listened to the debate, I wondered if there might be a way in which we could maintain the integrity of our position in favor of free trade while at the same time doing